Akshay Danthi

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SUMMARY

AI Product Manager combining technical depth with product judgment to build high-impact AI products. Leads product strategy, roadmaps, and cross-functional delivery from discovery through adoption, with hands-on experience developing enterprise AI agents, RAG systems, and AI analytics.

Featured Talk: Beyond RAG: AI Agent Playbooks | ACM: InfoNoms 2026

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Equifax Workforce Solutions (via Smartworks) — Mar 2026 - Present

AI Product Manager

Led product discovery, prioritization, and delivery for an enterprise AI and automation portfolio spanning customer support and internal operations; developed business cases and roadmaps based on workflow analysis, labor effort (FTEs), and operating costs, balancing projected ROI with implementation effort and technical feasibility.

Athena - AI Customer Support Agent:

- Owned Athena's product strategy and multiquarter roadmap, rolling out the Salesforce-integrated AI support copilot to **37 specialists handling ~2,800 employment authorization cases per month**, with a **15% reduction in average case resolution time** after launch.
- **Developed AI agent resolution playbooks** for **20 recurring case types**, combining LLM-assisted classification of **~13,000 cases** with specialist interviews to define when to retrieve guidance, query databases, or run backend actions.
- Launched case-aware chat with citations alongside automated case comments that recommended resolution steps and flagged missing required customer information. Specialists used chat on **60% of eligible cases**, with **82% positive feedback** among rated responses.
- Prioritized knowledge updates for SME review by grouping unanswered questions and tracing low-rated answers to the articles Athena cited.
- Built Athena's AI evaluation suite with golden datasets and LLM-as-judge grading. **90% of evaluated chat responses passed** all three checks for **groundedness, helpfulness, and PII leakage**. **85% of case comments reviewed by SMEs** received an "Accepted" rating.
- Partnered with engineering to establish a **Spec-Driven Development workflow**, connecting versioned specifications to agent-generated plans, tasks, code, and tests, with staged human review.

EVA Conversational AI Voice Agent:

- Owned product requirements and defined **15+ conversational intent workflows** to modernize IVR for The Work Number and Employer Services, enabling automated answers or live-agent routing with caller context.
- Defined and tracked EVA's success KPIs, targeting **30% lower average hold time**, **90%+ intent recognition accuracy**, and **95% routing accuracy**; prepared for launch with **15 red-team test scenarios** and phased rollout.

AD Consulting (Self-Employment) — Sep 2024 - Mar 2026

Founder & AI Product Builder

- Owned end-to-end AI product development across three VC, FinTech, and EdTech engagements, spanning user discovery, product strategy, roadmaps, hands-on development of RAG and agentic workflows using Claude Code and Cursor, technical tradeoffs, LLM evaluation, and delivery.
- **TheSprintFit**: Led 0-to-1 development of an AI platform for VC deal screening and founder-investor matching, **cutting deal evaluation time by ~70%**; defined the RAG evaluation strategy and quality gates across groundedness, hallucination, relevance, and retrieval quality, **improving grounding by 34%** and **reducing hallucinations by 62%**.
- **SowFin**: Interviewed **15 finance leaders**, uncovering concerns over sending confidential data to 3rd party LLM APIs; led development of a **self-hosted, fine-tuned Small Language Model** for visualization, converting **40% of interviewees to paid pilots.**

- **Majorly**: Led development of a real-time AI interview simulator, shaping conversational UX and requirements for latency and realism; drove **20% growth in weekly active usage in 6 weeks** and converted **3 pilots to paid customers**.

Mastercard *(via Wipro)* Mar 2022 - Aug 2023

Technical Product Manager

- Led the transformation of Mastercard's card program configuration platform into a self-service tool for issuer-facing teams, increasing onboarding **throughput by 5x** from **10 to 50+ organizations** per week.
- Defined the **prioritization strategy** for integrating 6 high-impact business capabilities into the self-service platform, including Tokenization, Risk Analytics, Loyalty, based on **business value, operational friction, integration readiness**.
- Drove **roadmap execution** across 15+ global stakeholders and a 9-person cross-functional team, balancing market-specific business and regulatory requirements to deliver iterative releases that achieved an **85% CSAT**.

HSBC *(via Infosys)* Nov 2019 - Mar 2022

Technical Business Analyst

- Elicited and analyzed business and regulatory requirements for HSBC's payments modernization in the UK & Saudi Arabia, including ISO 20022 transformation, Bacs enhancements, and mandated digital signatures for wage payments.
- Drove end-to-end business analysis across the transformation, including as-is/to-be process analysis, payment message mapping, requirements workshops, user stories, acceptance criteria, UAT, and release readiness.

Lloyds Banking Group *(via Virtusa)* Nov 2017 - Nov 2019

Software Engineer

- Built and maintained **Java** and **Oracle SQL** components for *Payments Control Manager*, supporting payment configuration and processing workflows for **100K+ daily** SWIFT transactions.
- Diagnosed defects, delivered code enhancements, supported testing, and resolved production issues for payment applications, collaborating with Business Analysts, QA, support, and upstream/downstream engineering teams.

EDUCATION

- M.S. in **Business Analytics** (Golden Gate University, San Francisco, CA) Sep 2023 - Sep 2024
- B.E. in **Computer Science** (Anna University, Chennai, India) Aug 2013 - Aug 2017

SKILLS

AI Product Management: Product strategy, 0-to-1 product development, user discovery, roadmap prioritization, KPI definition, product analytics, experimentation, AI product evaluation, stakeholder management, Jira, Confluence, GTM

GenAI / Agentic Systems: RAG, agentic workflows, Golden Dataset Design, MCP,agent tool integration,LLM evaluation, LLM as a judge, prompt and context engineering, hallucination testing,Guardrails,Responsible AI, AI architecture tradeoffs

Technical Product & Business Analysis: PRD Development, backlog management, JTBD, Agile delivery, systems integration, journey mapping, Spec Driven Development, API integration analysis, UAT prep, release readiness, knowledge governance

Data & Analytics: Python, SQL, Pandas, LLM-assisted thematic analysis, MS Excel, Data Visualization, Tableau, Power BI

Tools / Platforms: Salesforce,Google Cloud,LangGraph,ADK,AI Observability (+Langfuse), Google CCAI, Cursor, Claude Code

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified **AI/ML Product Management** (*AI Product Strategy, LLMOps, Pricing GenAI models*) - PMExercises (2024)
- **Generative AI Leader** *(Google Cloud GenAI, Model Output Optimization, GenAI Strategy)* - Google Cloud (2026)